Form 4B Informed Consent Assessment

Proposed answers for the Academic Early Warning System study

Study protocol title: AI-Powered Predictive Analytics for an Academic Early Warning System

Researchers: Kendrick O. Amparado; Christian Dave Estrañero Pombo; Ian Carlo B. Quimbo; Kent Ian C. Seridon.

Institution: Information Technology Department, College of Technologies, Bukidnon State University. Adviser: Czarissa A. Navidad.

Principal investigator: Confirm the designated PI. Reference number: To be issued upon RGAO registration. Code: To be issued by BukSU REC. Submission date: To be supplied.

How to use these answers

This response sheet follows all 33 elements in the supplied Form 4B. It provides study-specific proposed consent content. No standalone informed consent form (ICF) was identified in the materials reviewed, so an applicable element cannot yet be certified YES or assigned an actual ICF page and paragraph. For applicable items, leave YES unmarked until the finalized ICF contains the statement and its location is verified. N/A entries below are provisional applicability judgments for this nonclinical study.

All proposed safeguards and commitments require agreement by the research team and inclusion in the approved protocol and ICF. Bracketed details require confirmation. Reviewer comments, recommended action, approval, reviewer names, and signatures remain for BukSU REC; no ethics approval is asserted here.

Analysis that determines the answers

The study develops and evaluates AEWS through Design Science Research, stakeholder interviews, usability testing, and predictive-model evaluation. The software combines grades, attendance and needs assessments to support risk classification, referrals and human support decisions. Needs-assessment inputs include financial, family, physical-health and mental-health concerns, making privacy, distress and stigma material risks.

The manuscript proposes approximately 15 stakeholder interviews of 45–60 minutes each. The 1,000 model-ready student records describe the training dataset, not the number of people recruited for interviews or usability testing. Confirm the number of unique record subjects and all prospective participant groups separately.

Resolve a protocol inconsistency before submission: the Scope and Delimitations excludes extensive retention-outcome measurement, but Research Design proposes a historical-control comparison of retention and performance. The answers below follow the implemented development and evaluation scope; any retained comparison needs explicit procedures and record-use authorization.

Reference convention: p. means the printed manuscript page; PDF p. counts from the title page in the supplied paginated study copy. Paragraphs count nonempty Word paragraphs starting on that page, including headings, list entries and table cells. A paragraph continuing from a previous page is referenced at its starting page. These references describe the downloaded Word export as rendered on 23 October 2026; Google Docs pagination may differ. They are study references, not ICF locations.

Proposed responses to Form 4B

For every Pending ICF item: YES remains unverified; actual ICF page and paragraph must be added after finalization. The headings below summarize the corresponding numbered form elements.

1 Research statement

Pending ICF. You are invited to participate in a research capstone study on the development and evaluation of the Academic Early Warning System (AEWS) at Bukidnon State University. Participation in research must be distinguished from routine academic monitoring and support services.

Study reference: p. 30, paragraph 4 (PDF p. 39), Research Design. Direct support for the research design; a participant-facing invitation is still needed.

2 Purpose of the study

Pending ICF. The study aims to develop and evaluate a web system that uses academic records, attendance and needs-assessment information to identify possible academic difficulty and support timely AMU referrals. It evaluates functionality, predictive performance, usability and institutional relevance. Improved grades, retention or individual outcomes are not guaranteed.

Study reference: p. 7, paragraphs 1–6 (PDF p. 16), Objectives; p. 10, paragraph 2 (PDF p. 19), Scope. Direct support for purpose and evaluation limits.

3 Treatments and random assignment

N/A. The implemented study does not involve clinical treatments or random assignment to treatment groups. The manuscript proposes historical controls in one section; historical comparison is not random assignment. If that component remains, explain the groups and record access in the protocol and ICF.

Study reference: p. 31, paragraph 1 (PDF p. 40), Research Design, describes historical controls. No clinical treatment or random assignment is stated; N/A is an inference from the described design.

4 Study procedures including invasive procedures

Pending ICF. Stakeholder activities described in the manuscript include semi-structured interviews, system evaluation and a System Usability Scale questionnaire with feedback. Academic, attendance and needs-assessment records are linked by Student_ID for model development and prediction. State which activities apply to each participant group and whether interviews or discussions are recorded. No invasive procedures or biological sampling are described.

Study reference: p. 31, paragraph 1 (PDF p. 40); p. 33, paragraph 3 (PDF p. 42); p. 61, paragraph 4 (PDF p. 70). These support interviews, discussions and usability evaluation. Recording and invasive procedures are not specified.

5 Participant responsibilities

Pending ICF. Participants will complete only the agreed interview, evaluation tasks or questionnaire and give feedback based on their experience. Authorized staff should use approved test records and protect account credentials. Students who consent to research use of their records or responses must be told exactly what will be used. Explain whether sensitive questions may be skipped without losing access to support.

Study reference: p. 23, paragraphs 2–3 (PDF p. 32), Concept of the Study; p. 61, paragraph 4 (PDF p. 70), Evaluation. These describe system roles and feedback activities; participant obligations and permission to skip questions are not stated.

Proposed responses to Form 4B

For every Pending ICF item: YES remains unverified; actual ICF page and paragraph must be added after finalization. The headings below summarize the corresponding numbered form elements.

6 Duration of participation

Pending ICF. The manuscript specifies 45–60 minutes for each requirements interview. It does not establish the duration or number of usability sessions, questionnaires, focus groups or student follow-ups. Insert the verified schedule for each group; do not use the software development sprint schedule as the duration of participant involvement.

Study reference: p. 33, paragraph 3 (PDF p. 42), Requirements Gathering and Analysis: interviews lasting 45–60 minutes. Durations for other research activities are not stated.

7 Approximate number of participants

Pending ICF. Approximately 15 purposively sampled stakeholder interviews are proposed. The total number of unique interviewees, usability evaluators, focus-group members and student participants remains to be confirmed. Separately disclose the number and source of student records used. The 1,000 training records cannot be presented as 1,000 consenting research participants without verification.

Study reference: p. 33, paragraph 3 (PDF p. 42): approximately 15 interviews. p. 29, paragraph 9 (PDF p. 38): 1,000 model-ready records. Neither establishes the total number of unique research participants.

8 Experimental aspects

Pending ICF. AEWS and its XGBoost-based risk predictions are being developed and evaluated. Predictions may be inaccurate or biased and do not establish a clinical diagnosis or a guaranteed academic outcome. The manuscript requires designated staff to review AI risk flags before a formal intervention. Distinguish automatic referral flags from human decisions on support.

Study reference: p. 9, paragraph 3 (PDF p. 18), Scope; p. 23, paragraph 1 (PDF p. 32), prediction limits; p. 31, paragraph 2 (PDF p. 40), human review. These support development and decision-support status.

9 Foreseeable risks and inconvenience

Pending ICF. Risks include time burden, discomfort discussing academic or personal difficulties, unauthorized disclosure, stigma from a risk label, inaccurate predictions and inappropriate referrals. Needs assessments can reveal financial, family, physical-health and mental-health concerns. Explain safeguards, optional questions, withdrawal and the response to distress or disclosure incidents. No pregnancy-specific procedure is described, but information disclosures may also affect family members.

Study reference: p. 31, paragraph 2 (PDF p. 40), bias and unfair-exclusion concerns; p. 37, paragraph 1 (PDF p. 46), sensitive assessment inputs; p. 33, paragraph 3 (PDF p. 42), interview time. The full participant risk disclosure and safeguards are not stated; privacy/code findings are separate implementation evidence.

10 Placebo risks

N/A. No placebo, medication or clinical treatment is described.

Study reference: p. 9, paragraph 3 (PDF p. 18), Scope, and p. 30, paragraph 4 (PDF p. 39), Research Design, provide nonclinical context only. Placebos are not discussed; N/A is inferred.

Proposed responses to Form 4B

For every Pending ICF item: YES remains unverified; actual ICF page and paragraph must be added after finalization. The headings below summarize the corresponding numbered form elements.

11 Expected benefits to participants

Pending ICF. Participants may gain experience with AEWS or contribute feedback that improves academic monitoring. Students may benefit from more timely human review and referral where ordinary services are available. Participation may provide no direct benefit; the system does not guarantee improved grades, continued enrollment or receipt of a particular service.

Study reference: p. 8, paragraphs 1–3 (PDF p. 17), Significance. These describe intended benefits, not guaranteed individual benefits. An explicit no-guarantee/no-direct-benefit statement is not present.

12 Benefits to the community and knowledge

Pending ICF. Findings may help BukSU improve academic monitoring, AMU referral workflows and the design of educational decision-support tools. The research can contribute evidence on software usability and academic-risk prediction. Broader reductions in dropout or improved retention remain potential benefits rather than outcomes established by this study.

Study reference: p. 8, paragraphs 4–5 (PDF p. 17) and p. 9, paragraph 1 (PDF p. 18), Significance. Direct support for institutional, policy and research contributions; p. 10, paragraph 2 (PDF p. 19) limits outcome evaluation.

13 Post-study access to a proven product or intervention

N/A for the specified clinical provision. No proven clinical study product or intervention is described. For software transparency, nevertheless explain that continued AEWS access depends on university authorization, maintenance and deployment decisions. Do not promise permanent access or describe the prototype as proven safe and effective.

Study reference: Not stated. p. 9, paragraph 3 (PDF p. 18) describes a software development project; it does not establish post-study access, continued hosting or a proven clinical intervention.

14 Alternative procedures or treatment

Pending ICF. For this nonclinical study, the relevant alternative is declining research participation while continuing ordinary university academic advising, mentoring and available support services. State that existing services remain available under their usual eligibility rules. Confirm the specific services and access route; do not promise a clinical treatment.

Study reference: p. 23, paragraph 4 (PDF p. 32), Concept, states that AEWS supplements existing support procedures. No explicit guarantee of continued services after declining research is stated; that provision remains proposed.

15 Treatment insurance or compensation for study injury

Pending ICF. No study-specific insurance, treatment entitlement or injury-compensation arrangement is documented. The team must confirm and disclose the actual policy, including who handles distress or other research-related harm and where assistance can be sought. A noninvasive study can still cause informational or psychological harm; do not simply mark this N/A or promise coverage.

Study reference: Not stated in the study. No verified paragraph establishes study-injury treatment, insurance or compensation entitlements.

Proposed responses to Form 4B

For every Pending ICF item: YES remains unverified; actual ICF page and paragraph must be added after finalization. The headings below summarize the corresponding numbered form elements.

16 Payments or material incentives

Pending ICF. Payment and reimbursement arrangements are not established in the manuscript. Confirm whether there is no payment or whether an incentive is offered; if offered, state the exact type, amount, timing and treatment of withdrawal. Do not claim that participants will be paid or that no payment exists without confirmation.

Study reference: Not stated in the study. No verified paragraph specifies participant payment, incentives or reimbursement.

17 Compensation for disability or death

Pending ICF. No arrangement for disability or death arising from research-related injury is documented. Obtain the institution's actual policy and state whether any study-specific compensation exists. Do not promise compensation, insert a waiver of participant rights, or infer an insurance entitlement from the study's nonclinical nature.

Study reference: Not stated in the study. No verified paragraph establishes compensation or a no-compensation policy for disability or death.

18 Participant expenses

Pending ICF. Confirm whether participation requires transport, mobile data, internet access, printing or personal-device use, and whether costs will be reimbursed. Disclose foreseeable costs and any university-provided facilities. No verified amount or no-cost arrangement is available in the reviewed study.

Study reference: Not stated in the study. Hardware and connectivity requirements do not establish participant expenses or reimbursement.

19 Voluntary participation and withdrawal

Pending ICF. Participation is voluntary. Refusal or withdrawal must not affect grades, employment, standing or ordinary support entitlements. Explain the withdrawal contact and deadline for removing identifiable research data, including limits once data are irreversibly anonymized or results aggregated. Distinguish withdrawal from research from retention of official university records under institutional rules.

Study reference: Not stated in the study. The ethics discussion at p. 31, paragraph 2 (PDF p. 40) does not specify voluntariness, withdrawal, penalties or data-removal limits.

20 Access to medical records for clinical-trial verification

N/A. This is not a clinical trial and no access to clinical medical records is described. Self-reported health concerns in a needs assessment still require protection. Separately disclose any authorized REC review of research records, the purpose and confidentiality limits; do not use this item to authorize unrestricted access to student records.

Study reference: p. 29, paragraph 9 (PDF p. 38), Data, describes academic and needs-assessment records. No clinical-trial medical-record verification provision is stated; N/A is inferred from the described materials.

Proposed responses to Form 4B

For every Pending ICF item: YES remains unverified; actual ICF page and paragraph must be added after finalization. The headings below summarize the corresponding numbered form elements.

21 Confidentiality and its limitations

Pending ICF. The ICF must identify the records collected, research purpose, authorized recipients, storage location, retention period, deletion method and publication safeguards. Propose coded research extracts, a separately protected linkage key and aggregate reporting. Explain that confidentiality cannot be absolute and describe any approved disclosure limits. The code contains public student-data routes and a header-based authentication fallback, so unrestricted claims of secure or confidential access are not supported.

Study reference: p. 7, paragraph 3 (PDF p. 16), privacy-related objective; p. 31, paragraph 2 (PDF p. 40), ethics; p. 37, paragraph 1 (PDF p. 46), sensitive inputs. These provide context, not a complete confidentiality promise, retention schedule or publication policy. Access-control gaps come from code review, not a study paragraph.

22 Genetic tests and familial genetic information

N/A. No genetic testing or familial genetic-information collection is described. Ordinary family concerns in a needs assessment are not genetic testing.

Study reference: p. 37, paragraph 1 (PDF p. 46) describes ordinary family and health concerns, not genetic testing. No genetic-information policy is stated; N/A is inferred.

23 Secondary use of medical records and biological specimens

N/A for the specified materials. No clinical medical records or biological specimens are described. Separately disclose research use of academic records and health-related self-reports, including whether model training, future retraining or sharing is permitted. Obtain the required permission or approved waiver; routine possession of student records does not establish research authorization.

Study reference: p. 29, paragraph 9 (PDF p. 38) identifies the model-development records. No biological specimens or clinical medical-record secondary-use provision is stated. Research authorization and future reuse permissions are not established by this paragraph.

24 Storage or destruction of biological specimens

N/A. No biological specimens are collected or stored. For digital research records, the team must still specify an approved retention period, storage location, access restrictions, deletion process, backup handling and any limits on removing data from completed analyses or trained models.

Study reference: Not stated for biological specimens or digital-data retention/destruction. p. 29, paragraph 9 (PDF p. 38) establishes dataset context only; it supplies no storage duration or deletion commitment.

25 Commercial products from biological specimens

N/A. No biological specimens or specimen-derived commercial products are involved. If AEWS software or research data may later be commercialized, disclose that separately; do not infer that there is no software commercialization plan merely because this biological-specimen item is inapplicable.

Study reference: Not stated. The study describes software development at p. 9, paragraph 3 (PDF p. 18); no specimen-based commercial development is described and no software-commercialization policy is established.

Proposed responses to Form 4B

For every Pending ICF item: YES remains unverified; actual ICF page and paragraph must be added after finalization. The headings below summarize the corresponding numbered form elements.

26 New information affecting willingness to continue

Pending ICF. Proposed statement: We will inform you promptly of significant new information that may affect your willingness to continue, including material changes in procedures, data use, privacy risk or findings about prediction reliability. Explain how participants will be contacted and whether renewed consent will be sought.

Study reference: Not stated in the study. No verified paragraph commits to notifying participants about new information or obtaining renewed consent.

27 Participant access to study results

Pending ICF. Propose providing an understandable summary of overall findings through the research team after completion. Confirm the request contact, delivery method and expected availability. Individual academic-risk displays are not equivalent to the research results and must be explained separately without exposing other students' information.

Study reference: Not stated for access to research findings. p. 23, paragraph 3 (PDF p. 32) concerns students viewing academic information; p. 61, paragraph 4 (PDF p. 70) concerns evaluation. Neither promises a research-results summary.

28 Participant access to personal records

Pending ICF. Explain how participants can request access to or correction of their own research information and academic-source errors through the designated researcher or university office. State identity-verification requirements and any justified limits protecting others. Research withdrawal does not automatically erase official academic records. A working correction or access process has not been verified.

Study reference: p. 23, paragraph 3 (PDF p. 32) and p. 10, paragraph 1 (PDF p. 19) describe dashboard access. No explicit research-record access, correction or withdrawal/deletion rights procedure is stated.

29 Termination of participation

Pending ICF. Specify approved reasons such as participant request, ineligibility, inability to consent, unacceptable privacy or safety risk, or suspension of the study by the institution or REC. Explain what happens to existing data and support access. A high-risk prediction alone should not be presented as a reason for excluding or penalizing a participant.

Study reference: Not stated in the study. No verified paragraph identifies conditions for ending research participation or the handling of data afterward.

30 Sponsor affiliation and funding

Pending ICF. The researchers are BS Information Technology capstone students in the Information Technology Department, College of Technologies, Bukidnon State University. The manuscript names Czarissa A. Navidad as adviser. Funding, sponsorship and relevant conflicts of interest are not established; confirm them before stating that the study is self-funded or externally sponsored.

Study reference: Title page, paragraphs 3–8 (PDF p. 1), identifies researchers and institutional affiliation; Approval Sheet, paragraphs 3–4 (PDF p. 2), identifies the adviser. Sponsorship, funding and conflicts are not stated.

Proposed responses to Form 4B

For every Pending ICF item: YES remains unverified; actual ICF page and paragraph must be added after finalization. The headings below summarize the corresponding numbered form elements.

31 Investigator and healthcare-provider roles

Pending ICF. The named researchers are IT capstone investigators; no healthcare-provider role is documented for them. State their actual role and distinguish research duties from academic evaluation or mentoring roles. Where a recruiter also supervises, grades or supports participants, explain safeguards against pressure to participate.

Study reference: Title page, paragraphs 2–11 (PDF p. 1), establishes an IT capstone context. The absence of a healthcare-provider role is inferred; no explicit dual-role or coercion safeguard is stated.

32 Research-team and harm contacts

Pending ICF. Insert the confirmed principal investigator's name, institutional email and phone number, plus the adviser or designated contact for research-related concerns or harm. Identify how urgent distress will be referred to an appropriate university service. Do not use placeholder emails or invent contact information.

Study reference: Title page, paragraphs 3–6 (PDF p. 1), names researchers; Approval Sheet, paragraphs 3–4 (PDF p. 2), names the adviser. No research-contact email, phone or harm-contact procedure is stated.

33 REC approval and rights or complaint contacts

Pending ICF and REC confirmation. Do not state that BukSU REC has approved the study until written approval is issued. Once approved, insert the verified approval reference/date and REC chair's name, address, email, telephone and mobile contact as required by the form. Provide an independent route for questions about rights, grievances or complaints.

Study reference: Not stated in the study. The Approval Sheet (PDF p. 2) concerns capstone acceptance and is not evidence of BukSU REC approval. No verified REC approval reference or REC complaint contacts are supplied.

Actions before completing the official checklist

1. Resolve the historical-control comparison versus the stated limits on retention-outcome research, and use the same final procedures throughout the protocol and ICF.
2. Confirm the PI, all participant groups and counts, usability-session duration, recording arrangements, eligibility criteria and whether any students are minors. If minors are included, obtain REC direction on parental permission and assent.
3. Finalize a participant-facing ICF with role-specific procedures, voluntary participation, record-use authorization, risks, costs, payments, harm arrangements, contacts and privacy provisions. Explain the language and consent process so participants can understand and ask questions.
4. Confirm the provenance of the 1,000 records, unique data-subject count, institutional authorization and consent or approved waiver for research/model training. Institutional permission and individual consent serve different purposes.
5. Address and verify public student-data access and the trusted-header authentication fallback before using identifiable participant data. This was a source-code review, not a live security test. Role checks and token support alone do not establish effective protection on every route.
6. Approve the retention and deletion schedule, authorized research recipients, handling of health-related responses and withdrawal limits. Account for exports, email invitations, backups and model artifacts.
7. After finalizing and paginating the ICF, enter its actual page and paragraph for each applicable item and mark YES only where the element is present. Confirm provisional N/A judgments with the PI/REC. Leave reviewer decisions and signatures to the reviewers.

Evidence reviewed

1. Supplied Form 4B Informed Consent Assessment Form.docx, including all 33 checklist elements and the PI/reviewer sections.

2. Linked manuscript, downloaded as Word and paginated with Microsoft Word on 23 October 2026. Each answer supplies printed manuscript pages, PDF page positions, and nonempty paragraph numbers. The accompanying AEWS Study Paginated Reference PDF fixes the page layout used for these references. No separately identified participant ICF was found.

Study source:
https://docs.google.com/document/d/1aeEmgcyqNRXyvTXZaaStXGvsF_ZwHoV3OWi_0VWh50k/edit

3. Local implementation: backend/app/ai_features.py (model features and sensitive needs-assessment inputs); backend/app/authz.py (token validation and header fallback); backend/app/routers/students.py (public profile/dashboard routes); backend/app/main.py (public router registration); backend/app/routers/amu_staff.py (needs assessments, predictions and support routing); backend/DATASET_SOURCES.md (training-record documentation).